

Champions Baulked in Bid for 13th Hurling Title. Fohenagh Draw with Castlegar in Thrilling Final.

CASTLEGAR 1-11. FOHENAGH 2-8.

HOLDERS of twelve senior county hurling titles, Castlegar's bid for this year's County Cup almost met with an "unlucky thirteen" fate when they were held to level scores by Fohenagh in one of the best finals of recent years at Pearse Stadium, Salthill, on Sunday.

Fohenagh, who had been completely routed by the champions last year, were not at all over-awed by the task before them, and they played grand hurling all through the hour. They held the lead at half-time and looked like new champions by a point margin until Paddy Egan levelled the scoring with minutes to go. "Cashel" seemed to have their thirteenth title "in the bag" when they were awarded a free but Padraic Nolan's shot sliced wide to leave it a draw.

And while Castlegar may have been unlucky not to have gained the laurels, there was no doubt at all that Fohenagh had done more than enough to earn a second chance. They surprised not only Castlegar but their own fervent followers with a display of speed and craft that made them worthy challengers. Castlegar's traditional finish almost pulled them through, and for the second time this year it saved them from a shock defeat. Athenry held them to a draw in the first round, and now Fohenagh have done the same thing in the final.

Hurling games in this county have frequently been marred by rough play and unsporting incidents, but Sunday's final did much to wipe these blots off the records. Here was a game contested with spirit and vigour but with never a trace of bad temper or unfair tactics.

Both sides deserved credit for such a fine display, and the talent shown by some of the young hurlers on view gives hope that Galway hurling may soon be revived to its highest level.

Playing in ideal conditions, two fit and well trained teams, served up close, hard hurling, and in the second quarter especially there were some rousing spells of air and ground hurling that provided a full quota of thrills for the big attendance. After such a performance, a draw was indeed a fair result for both sides.

If Fohenagh had turned the trick of defeating the powerful Castlegar side, much of the credit would have gone to their tall midfielder, clerical student Nicholas Murray, who gave them splendid service. But when Kevin Shaughnessy struck his best form, he restored the balance for Castlegar, even though Murray was never completely subdued.

Tuam Athletes Helped Galway Beat Derry.

GALWAY qualified for the All-Ireland final in the N.A.C.A. inter-county athletic championships when they defeated the Ulster champions, Derry, by 113 points to 75 at Ballina on Sunday last.

While Derry scored well in the cycle and middle distance events, they could not match the Galway athletes in the sprints and field events.

Matt Smyth was the Derry star, winning the 880 and mile in excellent style, while Galway had Martin Clancy doing 22ft. 4ins., one of the best long jumps this year. He also won the youths' event with 21ft. 8ins.

Eamon Quinn, the Galway city colleges champion, was in great form to win the senior 100 and 220 yards and the youths' 220 yards.

Tuam members of the team scored well, with Jarlath King running a good second to Gus O'Gorman (Galway) in the 440 and earlier being placed fourth in the 880 yards.

16-year-old Billy Glynn had several jumps of over 20 feet to his credit, and his final effort of 20ft. 7 ins. won him third place in the event.

Harry Campbell ran into some trouble in the mile that knocked him off his stride, after which he failed to get placed.

The relay race, last event of the day, proved the most exciting. Galway dropped the baton on the second change and this cost them considerable ground, but a series of good "legs" by Quinn, Condon, King and Glynn cut the deficit to 15 yards. Gus O'Gorman then put in a great burst to snatch a slight lead which Callanan held to the end.

Inspired by Murray's display, the Fohenagh men had another star in veteran Tim Sweeney, whose speed and craft spelt danger for the champions whenever he got possession. His shot to the square from a free in the second half almost won the game when Aidan Murray finished it for a shock goal.

Castlegar's top defender was Tommy Broderick, whose close marking and well directed clearances repelled many Fohenagh raids. John Molloy, playing his third match since returning to active service, made up for lack of pace with craft and his long drives from frees were a great asset.

Pat Shaughnessy was a very able partner for his brother Kevin at midfield, and Stephen Francis, Seamus Cullinane, and Tommy Egan were prominent in defence.

Tommy Collins was "Cashels" best forward, and Paddy Egan also was a tireless worker, but Padraic Nolan and the rest were well held by a sound Fohenagh defence.

Jim Moclair starred in this sector for the challengers, and Marty Glynn, Pat Joe Lally and Tony O'Gorman proved well able for the best Castlegar could offer.

In attack, neither Frankie nor Tommy Glynn showed up so prominently as usual, and it was Tim Sweeney, Aidan Murray and Liam Manning who took scoring honours. Fohenagh, who led by 1-6 to 0-7 at half-time, got their scores from A. Murray (0-1), F. Glynn (0-1), T. Sweeney (0-4) and L. Manning (1-0). Castlegar's points came from J. Molloy, E. Abberton, P. Egan, T. Collins and P. Shaughnessy.

In the second half, Fohenagh were a goal ahead when Nick Murray pointed, but P. Egan and K. Shaughnessy cut the lead to a point before Collins goalied to give "Cashel" the lead. Nolan pointed a free, but it was all square when Aidan Murray drove in a goal for Fohenagh. Tim Sweeney put them a point ahead but Paddy Egan levelled off a free, and it was a drawn game when Nolan missed the chance of giving Castlegar their thirteenth title. Final scores were: Castlegar, 1-11; Fohenagh, 2-8.

Castlegar: J. Carr; S. Francis, S. Cullinane, T. Broderick; T. Egan, J. Molloy, J. Corcoran; P. Shaughnessy, K. Shaughnessy; P. Nolan, P. Egan, T. Collins; C. Egan, E. Abberton, M. Coyne.

Fohenagh: F. Madden; J. Moclair, J. Sweeney, T. Molyette; A. O'Gorman, M. Glynn, P. J. Lally; N. Murray, N. Coen; T. Sweeney, L. Manning, T. Glynn; F. Glynn, A. Murray, G. Sweeney. Subs.: T. Killilea for M. Coen; P. Carroll for J. Sweeney.

GORT MINORS WON BY 28 POINTS.

In the minor final, Gort gave a brilliant display in routing Fohenagh on the scores 6-17 to 1-4. The winners were superior in all sections, and were well worth their 28 points winning margin.

HEADFORD'S 10 POINTS MARGIN OVER ATHENRY.

HEADFORD 4-5. ATHENRY 2-1.

HEADFORD proved too good for Athenry in the North Board Junior Football Championship at Tuam Stadium on Sunday last and won by a margin of ten points.

They were slow, however, to show their superiority on the scoreboard, and while they had the greater part of the play in the first half held only a goal lead at the interval. That was due mainly to poor forward work, while elsewhere they almost dominated the exchanges. In the second half they rained in three goals and Athenry had 1-1 in reply.

Even though Headford were well on top throughout, Athenry did not give up easily and fought hard to the final whistle. However, the winners display was too much for them and they had no answer to the fine kicking and direct methods of the Corrib side.

Gerry Lee and Paddy Curran were seldom beaten at midfield, and in an attack led by Cecil Canney, with "Junior" Walsh, Paddy Halloran and big Gabriel Collieran, the Athenry backs had a busy time. Headford's defence was also sound, and here Tom O'Toole, the Walshes and Fursa O'Connor were seldom caught out.

Best triers on the Athenry team were Sean Dempsey, Leo Gardiner, Kevin Whelan and Poyntz in attack, while Paddy Coady, Bobby Gardiner and C. Molyette worked hard in defence.

Athenry drew "first blood" when F. Healy goalied in the first few minutes. Then Paddy Halloran and Cecil Canney had Headford points and G. Lee goalied. Gabriel Collieran boxed over a point to leave the half-time scores:

Headford, 1-3; Athenry, 1-0. Headford had a goal and a point in rapid order on the resumption, and Bobby Gardiner had Athenry's only goal in reply. John Joyce had another Headford goal and J. Poyntz replied with a point for Athenry. In the closing stages Cecil Canney had a goal and a point for Headford to leave them easy winners on the scores: 4-5 to 2-1.

Headford: T. Murphy; M. Redington, F. O'Connor, T. O'Toole; S. Walsh, J. Walsh, P. Walsh; P. Curran, G. Lee; C. Canney, P. Walsh, J. Joyce; G. Collieran, Jnr. Walsh, P. Halloran. Athenry: J. Pollard; C. Cronnelly, C. Molyette, M. Quinn; P. Coady, J. O'Shea, J. Kearns; L. Gardiner, S. Dempsey; K. Whelan, J. Poyntz, B. Gardiner; F. Healy, E. Broady, D. Morris.

Mr. Miko Kelly (Tuam) refereed.

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